

Pubic Lice - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1374 | Child (12-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only assessment of suspected pubic lice in patients aged 12 years and older; not approved for real-patient or production use.
- Child patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] How old is the patient, where are lice or nits seen, and how long has itching been present?
2. [YES_NO] Can the patient speak privately and safely? For a child or adolescent, pubic lice requires an immediate Qatar-approved safeguarding assessment for possible sexual contact, abuse, or exploitation; do not question them in front of a potentially unsafe person.
3. [YES_NO] Is the patient pregnant or breastfeeding, immunocompromised, affected around the eyes, or allergic to lice treatments, and what medicines or treatments have already been used?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Head Lice

Are lice or eggs confined to scalp hair rather than pubic or coarse body hair?

Scalp lice belong in the Head Lice pathway.

1. Disposition level 50

Is pubic lice suspected or confirmed?

NHS.UK guidance recommends contacting a sexual-health clinic, primary-care clinician, or pharmacist for pubic lice - it will not resolve without treatment, and sexual partners should also be examined.

Advice

Pubic lice assessment and treatment

- Arrange pharmacist or clinician confirmation and use only a locally approved product exactly as labelled; suitability differs by age, pregnancy or breastfeeding, allergy, skin condition, and treatment site. Do not apply body products to eyelashes or eyes. Avoid close body or sexual contact until assessment and treatment are complete; partner notification and STI testing must follow the confidential Qatar pathway approved for UAT. For anyone under 18, prioritize safeguarding review before partner-contact advice. Launder clothing and bedding according to the selected product's instructions.
- Call Back If: eye involvement, skin infection, allergy, or symptoms persisting after correctly completed treatment; any safeguarding concern.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Pubic lice", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/pubic-lice/> (page last reviewed 15 May 2026)

Provenance

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